

THE NEW HOTSPOT
Apple's first retail store in India at the Bandra-Kurla Complex in Mumbai

₹57,390

CRORE
VALUE OF iPHONES ASSEMBLED BY APPLE IN INDIA IN 2022-23, THREE TIMES MORE THAN IN 2021-22

5%

SHARE OF iPHONES
MADE IN INDIA BY APPLE IN PARTNERSHIP WITH FIRMS SUCH AS FOXCONN, PEGATRON AND WISTRON

MANDAR DEODHAR



"WE SHARE YOUR VISION OF THE POSITIVE IMPACT TECHNOLOGY CAN MAKE ON INDIA'S FUTURE..."

–TIM COOK
CEO, APPLE INC

(On Twitter, after his meeting with the PM)

have already made plans to reduce their manufacturing dependence on China following trade sanctions that both countries had resorted to over the past few years. China had also imposed strict lockdowns in its key cities early in 2020 and as recently as the end of last year to battle Covid, causing serious disruptions in its manufacturing supply chains. This threw companies that depended on it into disarray, impacting their production.

Media reports say that Apple could shift half of its global iPhone production to India by the turn of the decade, though company executives declined to comment on such plans. Moreover, replicating such complex supply chains in India would be a tardy process. However, an intent to do more seems to be firmly in place. "We share your (Modi's) vision of the positive impact technology can make on India's future—from education and developers to manufacturing and the environment, we're committed to growing and investing across the country," Cook tweeted on April 19 after his meeting with PM Modi. Apple makes iPhones in India through partners such as Foxconn Technology Group, Pegatron and Wistron. However, almost 90 per cent of the components that go into the assembly of these iPhones are imported into the country, which means there's still a long way for the country to go in offering the right kind of ecosystem for top tech companies like Apple.

"Apple needs India because of its 'China plus one' strategy. But it is also true in Vietnam's case," says Navkendar Singh, associate vice president at IDC India, a research firm. Vietnam is indeed another destination on Apple's radar for its manufacturing. However, India has other advantages, too. Last November, the Union ministry for information & broadcasting said that India had over 1.2 billion mobile users, of whom 600 million were users of